

LOOPTRIPS

KERALA

Complete 2026 Travel Guide + SEO Internal Linking Plan

Content objective

A publish-ready Kerala state pillar designed for SEO, AEO, GEO/AI search, user experience, and a scalable internal-link architecture across destinations, itineraries, comparison pages, seasonal content, and booking-intent pages.

Prepared for Looptrips

Updated: September 2026

Kerala Pillar - SEO & Publishing Setup

Element	Recommendation
URL	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/
Meta title	Best Places to Visit in Kerala 2026 Looptrips
Meta description	Discover the best places to visit in Kerala, from Munnar and Alleppey to Varkala and Wayanad, with backwaters, itineraries, beaches, food, and travel tips.
H1	Best Places to Visit in Kerala: Complete 2026 Travel Guide
Primary keyword	best places to visit in Kerala
Secondary keywords	places to visit in Kerala; Kerala tourist places; Kerala tourism; Kerala travel guide; famous places in Kerala; Kerala itinerary
Long-tail targets	places to visit in Kerala with family; Kerala for couples; Kerala 7 day itinerary; hidden places in Kerala; Kerala in monsoon; Kerala road trip
Intent	Travel inspiration + trip planning + commercial investigation
Schema	CollectionPage + TouristDestination + ItemList + BreadcrumbList + FAQPage
Breadcrumb	Home > India > Kerala

Keyword rule

Use exact-match phrases where they read naturally, then vary anchors with close semantic versions. Do not repeat the same anchor every time a page is linked.

Best Places to Visit in Kerala: Complete 2026 Travel Guide

Kerala does not ask you to travel faster. It asks you to slow down.

To watch mist move across a tea-covered hill in Munnar. To sit beside a canal while a small boat disappears between coconut palms. To hear waves below Varkala's cliffs. To wake before the forest does in Thekkady. To eat something served on a banana leaf without checking your phone first.

And perhaps most importantly, to stop treating every trip like a race between tourist attractions.

That is Kerala.

Search for the best places to visit in Kerala, and you will quickly find the familiar names: Munnar, Alleppey, Kochi, Thekkady, Varkala and Wayanad.

They are famous for good reasons. But Kerala becomes much more interesting when you look beyond the standard Kochi - Munnar - houseboat - airport itinerary.

There is Kumarakom. Munroe Island. Vagamon. Athirappilly. Beypore. Kannur. Bekal. North Kerala's beaches and Theyyam traditions. Village experiences. Food journeys. Backwaters that do not require spending the night on a houseboat.

At Looptrips, we want to help you build Kerala as a journey, not collect it as a checklist.

Start with one question

What version of Kerala do you want to experience?

What Are the Best Places to Visit in Kerala?

For a first trip, the strongest starting points are Kochi, Munnar, Alappuzha, Thekkady and Varkala. Add Kumarakom when you want quieter backwaters. Choose Wayanad when forests, coffee country and road trips matter more than beaches. Add Athirappilly for waterfalls. Choose Vagamon when you want a quieter hill escape. Look at Munroe Island when a small-boat backwater experience sounds better than a large houseboat. Travel north toward Kozhikode, Kannur and Bekal when you want to see a side of Kerala many first-time itineraries ignore.

1. Kochi: Start Where Kerala's Stories Meet the Sea

Kochi is an excellent first chapter - not because it gives you Kerala's most dramatic scenery, but because it immediately shows you that Kerala has always been connected to somewhere else.

Walk through Fort Kochi and Portuguese, Dutch, British, Jewish, Arab and Indian histories begin overlapping. Chinese fishing nets rise above the waterfront. St. Francis Church, Mattancherry, spice history, cafes, galleries and ferry rides all sit surprisingly close together.

For a first trip, give Kochi one or two nights. One full day can cover the highlights. Two lets you stop treating Fort Kochi as a sightseeing route and actually enjoy being there.

Looptrips route: Kochi -> Munnar -> Thekkady -> Alappuzha.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-kochi/>

2. Munnar: Wake Up Inside Kerala's Tea Country

Munnar is the Kerala destination people recognize before they have visited it. Tea estates roll across the mountains. Roads curve through intensely green slopes. Clouds drop low enough to hide entire hillsides.

Official 2025 Kerala Tourism statistics recorded Munnar as the state's most-visited destination among domestic tourists, which also explains why timing matters when planning your visit.

Is Munnar worth two nights? Yes. One night means arriving, sightseeing and leaving. Two nights gives you an actual mountain stay. Three can work beautifully if the purpose of the trip is to slow down rather than complete an attraction list.

Perfect for: couples, families, road trips, photography, nature and cooler-weather escapes.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-munnar/>

3. Alappuzha: Don't Just Book a Houseboat and Leave

Alappuzha, also widely called Alleppey, is one of India's best-known backwater destinations. But the backwaters are more than a floating hotel. They are villages, canals, paddy fields, fishing, coir-making, small boats, schools, homes and everyday life organized around water.

You can stay overnight on a houseboat, but you do not have to. Some travellers prefer a smaller canoe or country-boat experience that moves deeper into narrow canals and closer to village life.

The useful question is not "Do I have to stay on a houseboat because I am in Kerala?" It is "What kind of backwater experience do I actually want?"

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-alappuzha/>

4. Kumarakom: Backwaters Without the Alleppey Energy

Alappuzha and Kumarakom share the world of Vembanad Lake, but they do not feel identical. Kumarakom is a strong choice when you want your backwater experience to feel more like a retreat: birdlife, water, mangroves, quiet resorts and village landscapes.

Choose Alappuzha if the classic houseboat experience is one of your priorities. Choose Kumarakom if you want a quieter backwater stay, birding and a slower resort-style experience.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-kumarakom/>

5. Thekkady: Kerala Gets Wilder Here

Drive out of Munnar and Kerala changes again. Tea country begins giving way to spice-growing landscapes and forest. Then you reach Thekkady.

The major draw is the Periyar landscape, where lake, forest and wildlife experiences come together. The area also works for travellers interested in spice plantations, nature walks and slower hill-country stays.

Like every wildlife destination, Periyar should never be sold as a guaranteed animal-sighting experience. The forest does not follow an itinerary. That is part of the point.

Looptrips route: Munnar -> Thekkady -> Kumarakom or Alappuzha.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-thekkady/>

6. Varkala: Kerala's Beach With an Edge

Varkala gives Kerala's coastline something unusual: height. Its red laterite cliffs rise above the Arabian Sea, creating a very different beach landscape from much of Kerala's flatter coast.

Walk the cliff. Watch sunset. Eat facing the sea. Take the stairs down to the beach. Then stay another day.

Varkala generally fits travellers looking for cliff views, cafes, a younger independent-travel atmosphere, yoga and a more walkable beach stay. Kovalam works well for travellers wanting an established resort-style beach destination close to Thiruvananthapuram.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-varkala/>

7. Wayanad: Kerala for People Who Prefer Forests to Beaches

Wayanad does not feel like coastal Kerala - and that is why it belongs on this list. Forests, coffee and spice plantations, mountain roads, lakes, waterfalls, trekking and Edakkal Caves give it a different travel rhythm.

Choose Munnar when tea landscapes and classic hill-station scenery are your priority. Choose Wayanad when you want a broader road-trip destination combining forests, lakes, caves, plantations and adventure.

Wayanad fits particularly well into a journey arriving through Kozhikode or travelling from Bengaluru or Mysuru. For a first Kerala trip arriving in Kochi with only six or seven days, adding Wayanad can create unnecessary travel.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-wayanad/>

8. Athirappilly: Follow the Sound of the Water

You often hear Athirappilly before you fully see it. Water drops through an intensely green forest landscape. Mist rises. The river continues downstream toward Vazhachal.

Athirappilly is especially dramatic during wetter periods, but more water also means different trail and road conditions. The waterfall should never be treated as a social-media backdrop without checking the weather first.

It works particularly well around Kochi or as part of a road journey connecting central Kerala.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-athirappilly/>

9. Vagamon: When You Want the Hills Without Repeating Munnar

Vagamon is not Munnar's smaller copy. Munnar is dominated visually by tea estates. Vagamon is more about rolling grasslands, mist, pine areas and open hill landscapes.

Choose Munnar for a first classic Kerala hill experience. Choose Vagamon when you have already seen Munnar, want a quieter landscape, or prefer the journey itself to be the attraction.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-vagamon/>

10. Munroe Island: See the Backwaters From a Smaller Boat

Munroe Island may be one of the best examples of why Kerala's backwater story should not end in Alappuzha. Located where Ashtamudi Lake and the Kallada River meet, it is a network of canals, village landscapes and islands where smaller boat experiences can feel much more intimate.

Choose Alleppey for the iconic Kerala backwater experience. Choose Munroe Island if narrow canals, small boats and a village atmosphere sound more appealing.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-munroe-island/>

11. Thiruvananthapuram and Kovalam: Don't Treat the Capital as an Airport

Many travellers fly into Thiruvananthapuram and immediately leave for Varkala or Kovalam. That works, but it also means missing Kerala's capital.

Thiruvananthapuram can bring city history, museums, temples, food and culture into a beach-focused southern Kerala route. Kovalam works especially well when you want a beach stay close to the capital and airport.

Looptrips route: Varkala -> Thiruvananthapuram -> Kovalam.

Target pages: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-thiruvananthapuram/> and </kerala/places-to-visit-in-kovalam/>

12. Kozhikode and Beypore: Come to North Kerala Hungry

Kozhikode makes an excellent gateway to a different Kerala: the Malabar Coast, maritime history, markets, beaches, food and a long connection to the Indian Ocean trade network.

Kozhikode should become one of Looptrips' major food-content hubs. Here the question is not simply "What attractions should I see?" It is "What should I eat between them?"

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-kozhikode/>

13. Kannur: Go North for Beaches, Culture and Theyyam

Kannur is one of the reasons Looptrips should not build Kerala only around Kochi. North Malabar combines beaches, colonial history, backwaters and a particularly strong association with Theyyam.

Theyyam is a living ritual tradition, not a staged tourist costume show. Come to experience respectfully, not to turn a ritual into content production.

Nearby Muzhappilangad adds another unusual coastal experience.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-kannur/>

14. Bekal: Kerala's Fort by the Arabian Sea

Rajasthan has forts above cities. Kerala has Bekal overlooking the sea. The fort and surrounding coast give North Kerala a visual character very different from the classic South Kerala circuit.

Combine Bekal with beaches, North Malabar food and a Kannur or Kasaragod journey. Build North Kerala as its own route instead of a rushed extension from Varkala or Munnar.

Target page: </kerala/places-to-visit-in-bekal/>

Kerala's Classic Route vs the Kerala Most People Miss

A first-time Kerala journey will often revolve around Kochi -> Munnar -> Thekkady -> Alappuzha -> Varkala. That is a good route because the destinations complement each other. But it is not the whole state.

A second journey could instead look like Kozhikode -> Wayanad -> Kannur -> Bekal. Now the food changes. The cultural context changes. The beaches change. The road changes. And suddenly Kerala feels new again.

Where Should First-Time Visitors Go in Kerala?

If you have never visited Kerala before, do not try to cover the state from Kasaragod to Kovalam. Start with Kochi -> Munnar -> Thekkady -> Alappuzha. If you have another two days, finish in Varkala. This gives you city and heritage, hill country, wildlife, backwaters and beach without crossing the entire state.

How Many Days Are Enough for Kerala?

Time	What Makes Sense
3-4 days	One region: Kochi + Munnar, or Varkala + south Kerala
5 days	Kochi + Munnar + Alappuzha
7 days	Kochi + Munnar + Thekkady + Alappuzha + Varkala
10 days	Slow the classic route and add Kumarakom, Athirappilly or another focused stop
14 days	Begin considering Wayanad and/or a North Malabar extension

Looptrips planning rule
Do less. Experience more.

A 7-Day Kerala Itinerary That Actually Works

- Day 1 - Kochi: Arrive and explore Fort Kochi and Mattancherry without immediately disappearing into the hills.

2. Day 2 - Kochi to Munnar: Let the road become part of the trip. Arrive without packing the afternoon with sightseeing.
3. Day 3 - Munnar: Tea country, viewpoints, surrounding landscapes and time to actually enjoy the climate.
4. Day 4 - Munnar to Thekkady: Move from tea country toward forest and spice-growing landscapes.
5. Day 5 - Thekkady to Alappuzha: Trade the hills for water. Choose the backwater experience that fits you.
6. Day 6 - Alappuzha to Varkala: Reach the coast and stop changing hotels for a moment.
7. Day 7 - Varkala: Walk the cliff, spend time by the beach and depart through Thiruvananthapuram when the schedule requires it.

A Better 10-Day Kerala Itinerary

Try Kochi -> Athirappilly -> Munnar -> Thekkady -> Kumarakom/Alappuzha -> Varkala. Do not add destinations simply because you suddenly have three extra days. Use some of that time to stay longer: two nights in Kochi instead of one, three in Munnar instead of racing through, a quieter backwater stay, and two full beach days.

North Kerala Itinerary: The Loop Most First-Time Guides Ignore

Try Kozhikode -> Wayanad -> Kannur -> Bekal. Start with food and maritime history in Kozhikode. Move inland toward Wayanad. Return to the Malabar Coast around Kannur. Finish near Bekal. This route deserves its own content cluster rather than being treated as an extension of South Kerala.

Best Places to Visit in Kerala With Family

For families, strong options include Kochi, Munnar, Thekkady, Alappuzha, Kumarakom, Wayanad and Kovalam. Route design matters more than the destination list. A family itinerary with fewer long transfers will usually beat one with more sightseeing.

Best Places to Visit in Kerala for Couples

Munnar remains an obvious choice, but Kerala has much more to offer couples than honeymoon resort packages. Try Varkala for the cliff and sea, Kumarakom for slow backwater days, Fort Kochi for cafes and walking, Wayanad for forest stays, Vagamon for hills, Bekal for a quieter coastal break, or Alappuzha if sleeping on the water is genuinely part of the dream.

Is Kerala Worth Visiting During the Monsoon?

Yes - but visit for the monsoon, not despite it. The rains transform waterfalls, forests and hill landscapes. Heavy rainfall can also affect roads, trekking, outdoor activities and local conditions, so never build a monsoon itinerary from last year's Reel. Check current conditions.

What Is the Best Time to Visit Kerala?

For many first-time sightseeing trips, roughly October through March offers comfortable conditions across a large part of the state. But Kerala has no single season: choose cooler months for classic sightseeing, monsoon for waterfalls and deep green landscapes, and current ritual calendars for culture-led travel such as Theyyam.

North Kerala or South Kerala?

Choose South and Central Kerala for a first classic itinerary: Kochi, Munnar, Thekkady, Alappuzha, Varkala and Kovalam. Choose North Kerala when you want Wayanad, Kozhikode food, Beypore's maritime heritage, Kannur beaches, Theyyam traditions, Muzhappilangad and Bekal.

Alappuzha or Kumarakom?

Choose Alappuzha for a wider range of boat experiences, canals and the classic houseboat image. Choose Kumarakom for a quieter Vembanad Lake stay, birding and resort-style backwater travel. If the itinerary is short, you do not need both.

Munnar or Wayanad?

Choose Munnar for tea landscapes, classic hill-station scenery and a natural fit with Kochi, Thekkady and Alappuzha. Choose Wayanad for forests, coffee and spice country, caves, lakes, adventure and a stronger fit with Kozhikode and northern Kerala.

Varkala or Kovalam?

Choose Varkala for cliffs, walkability, independent cafes, yoga and a distinctive coastal landscape. Choose Kovalam for a more established beach-resort experience and convenient proximity to Thiruvananthapuram.

Kerala's Hidden and Less-Rushed Places

Instead of overusing the phrase "hidden gem," focus on worthwhile alternatives. Consider Munroe Island instead of assuming every backwater trip requires Alleppey. Consider Vagamon when you have already visited Munnar. Look at Beypore when maritime culture interests you. Travel toward Kannur and Kasaragod for another version of the coast. Explore Gavi when regulated eco-tourism and forest experiences fit the trip.

What Instagram Reels Don't Show You About Kerala

- That perfect empty Munnar road may have traffic around the next popular viewpoint.
- That peaceful houseboat may be travelling through a busy section of the backwaters with many other boats.
- That enormous waterfall can have completely different access and safety conditions during heavy rain.
- That Varkala swimming clip may not show strong waves or changing sea conditions.
- That six-stop Kerala itinerary may spend far more time in a car than the Reel suggests.
- That "hidden" cafe may have become popular precisely because the Reel went viral.

Use social for inspiration; use Looptrips for planning

Let Reels answer "Where do I want to go?" Let Looptrips answer "How do I make that trip actually work?"

Experience Kerala Instead of Only Photographing It

Kerala's strongest long-term travel opportunity is not adding another viewpoint. It is helping travellers participate: village walks, fishing traditions, farm experiences, cooking, craft, local food, art forms, responsible homestays and cultural experiences. The Looptrips principle should be simple: do not only see Kerala - participate in it respectfully.

What Should You Eat in Kerala?

Kerala's food changes with geography, religion, community and coast. That means Looptrips should eventually create separate food guides for Kochi, Kozhikode, Malabar, Thalassery, Alappuzha and Travancore, as well as thematic guides for sadya traditions, seafood and street food. The useful question is not only "What food is Kerala famous for?" but "What should I eat in the part of Kerala I am already visiting?"

How Do You Get Around Kerala?

Kerala is long and narrow, so a route may look simple on a map while still requiring hours on winding hill roads. Combine road transfers, trains, local buses, ferries and flights where each makes sense. Open-jaw itineraries are especially useful: arrive in Kochi, travel south, and depart from Thiruvananthapuram instead of backtracking.

How Do You Plan Kerala Without Spending the Trip in a Car?

- If you have five days: stay around Kochi, Munnar and Alappuzha.
- If you have seven days: add one meaningful extension.
- If you want Wayanad: consider entering through Kozhikode.
- If you want Kannur and Bekal: make North Kerala the trip.
- If you want Varkala and Kovalam: depart from Thiruvananthapuram.

The biggest Kerala planning mistake is not choosing the wrong attraction. It is choosing destinations that do not belong in the same short itinerary.

Frequently Asked Questions About Kerala

Which is the most beautiful place in Kerala?

There is no objective answer. Munnar is ideal for tea-covered mountain scenery, Varkala for cliffs and sea, Alappuzha and Kumarakom for backwaters, Wayanad for forests and Bekal for coastal heritage.

What are the top five places to visit in Kerala?

For many first-time travellers, Kochi, Munnar, Alappuzha, Thekkady and Varkala create a strong shortlist because they provide five distinctly different experiences.

Is seven days enough for Kerala?

Yes, for one well-designed region. Seven days can cover a classic Kochi-Munnar-Thekkady-Alappuzha-Varkala route, but it is not enough to explore the whole state properly.

How many days are ideal for Kerala?

Around seven days works well for a first focused trip, ten days gives you a more relaxed classic route, and roughly two weeks allows you to consider a broader combination including northern destinations.

Which is better, Munnar or Alleppey?

They should not be compared directly. Munnar is a mountain destination; Alappuzha is a backwater destination. The reason the classic Kerala itinerary works is that you can experience both.

Which is better, Munnar or Wayanad?

Munnar fits the classic central Kerala route and is best known for tea landscapes. Wayanad works better for forest, plantation and adventure-focused trips, particularly when travelling through North Kerala.

Is Kerala good for couples?

Yes. Munnar, Kumarakom, Varkala, Wayanad, Fort Kochi, Vagamon, Alappuzha and Bekal can all work well depending on whether the couple prefers hills, beaches, culture or slow travel.

Is Kerala good for family trips?

Yes. Kochi, Munnar, Thekkady, Alappuzha, Kumarakom, Wayanad and Kovalam can form family-friendly itineraries when long road transfers are limited.

Is Kerala worth visiting during monsoon?

Yes, especially for green landscapes, waterfalls, Ayurveda-focused stays and a different atmosphere, but travellers should monitor current rain, road and weather conditions closely.

Which Kerala airport should I use?

It depends on the route. Kochi suits central Kerala and the classic Munnar-Alappuzha circuit. Thiruvananthapuram suits Varkala and south Kerala. Kozhikode works well for Wayanad and Malabar, while Kannur is useful for Kannur and Kasaragod.

Is North Kerala worth visiting?

Yes. Kozhikode, Wayanad, Kannur, Muzhappilangad, Beypore, Bekal and North Malabar cultural traditions provide a noticeably different experience from the classic central and south Kerala circuit.

Do I have to stay on a houseboat in Kerala?

No. You can experience the backwaters through day cruises, canoes, country boats, ferries or waterfront stays. The overnight houseboat is one option, not a compulsory Kerala experience.

Build Your Kerala Loop

Do not start by asking: "How many Kerala tourist places can I fit into seven days?"

Ask: "What do I want to remember about this trip?"

The mist over Munnar? The first quiet hour on the backwaters? A Fort Kochi evening? Rain hitting a tiled roof? The forest around Thekkady? The cliffs at Varkala? A breakfast in Kozhikode? A Theyyam ritual experienced respectfully in North Malabar?

Then build around that. Connect the places that belong together. Leave room for food. Leave room for rain. Leave room for the road. And leave at least one afternoon where absolutely nothing has been scheduled.

Because Kerala does not always reward the traveller who sees the most. Sometimes it rewards the traveller who finally stops moving.

Looptrips CTA

Choose your route. Slow the journey down. Start your Kerala Looptrip.

Kerala Internal Linking Plan

The Kerala pillar should be the central authority page. It should link downward to destination, itinerary, comparison and experience pages. Those child pages should link back to the Kerala pillar and laterally to the most relevant sibling pages. Use descriptive anchors naturally; avoid repeating one exact-match anchor everywhere.

A. Links From the Kerala Pillar Page

Source	Target page	Recommended anchors	Best placement
Kerala pillar	Munnar guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-munnar/	best places to visit in Munnar; Munnar tourist places; Munnar travel guide	Munnar destination section + "Munnar or Wayanad?"
Kerala pillar	Kochi guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-kochi/	places to visit in Kochi; Fort Kochi attractions; Kochi travel guide	Kochi section + first-time route
Kerala pillar	Alappuzha guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-alappuzha/	places to visit in Alleppey; Alappuzha backwaters; Kerala houseboat	Alappuzha section + backwater comparisons
Kerala pillar	Kumarakom guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-kumarakom/	places to visit in Kumarakom; Kumarakom backwaters	Kumarakom section + Alappuzha vs Kumarakom
Kerala pillar	Thekkady guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-thekkady/	places to visit in Thekkady; Periyar wildlife; Thekkady travel guide	Thekkady section + 7-day itinerary
Kerala pillar	Varkala guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-varkala/	places to visit in Varkala; Varkala beach; Varkala travel guide	Varkala section + Varkala vs Kovalam
Kerala pillar	Wayanad guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-wayanad/	places to visit in Wayanad; Wayanad tourist places; Wayanad road trip	Wayanad section + Munnar vs Wayanad + North Kerala
Kerala pillar	Athirappilly guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-athirappilly/	Athirappilly waterfalls; places to visit in Athirappilly; waterfalls in Kerala	Athirappilly section + 10-day itinerary
Kerala pillar	Vagamon guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-vagamon/	places to visit in Vagamon; Vagamon hill station; hill stations in Kerala	Vagamon section + hidden/less-rushed places
Kerala pillar	Munroe Island guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-munroe-island/	Munroe Island; Munroe Island backwaters; offbeat places in Kerala	Munroe Island section + hidden/less-rushed places
Kerala pillar	Thiruvananthapuram guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-thiruvananthapuram/	places to visit in Thiruvananthapuram; Trivandrum tourist places	Capital section + airport/transport section
Kerala pillar	Kovalam guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-kovalam/	places to visit in Kovalam; Kovalam beach; beaches in Kerala	Kovalam section + Varkala vs Kovalam
Kerala pillar	Kozhikode guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-kozhikode/	places to visit in Kozhikode; Kozhikode food; Calicut tourist places	Kozhikode section + food section + North Kerala route
Kerala pillar	Kannur guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-kannur/	places to visit in Kannur; Theyyam in Kerala; Kannur beaches	Kannur section + North Kerala route
Kerala pillar	Bekal guide /kerala/places-to-visit-in-bekal/	places to visit in Bekal; Bekal Fort; North Kerala beaches	Bekal section + North Kerala route

B. Itinerary, Seasonal & Comparison Pages to Link From the Kerala Pillar

Target content	Recommended URL	Anchor keywords	Link from section
5-day Kerala itinerary	/kerala/5-day-kerala-itinerary/	5 day Kerala itinerary; Kerala itinerary for 5 days	How many days + itinerary intro
7-day Kerala itinerary	/kerala/7-day-kerala-itinerary/	7 day Kerala itinerary; Kerala itinerary for one week	7-day itinerary section
10-day Kerala itinerary	/kerala/10-day-kerala-itinerary/	10 day Kerala itinerary; Kerala trip for 10 days	10-day itinerary section
Kerala family guide	/kerala/kerala-with-family/	Kerala family trip; places to visit in Kerala with family	Family section
Kerala couples guide	/kerala/kerala-for-couples/	Kerala for couples; romantic places in Kerala	Couples section
Kerala monsoon guide	/kerala/kerala-in-monsoon/	Kerala in monsoon; monsoon places in Kerala	Monsoon + best time sections
North Kerala road trip	/kerala/north-kerala-road-trip/	North Kerala road trip; North Kerala itinerary	North Kerala section
Best backwaters	/kerala/best-backwater-experiences/	Kerala backwaters; best backwaters in Kerala; Kerala houseboat	Alappuzha/Kumarakom/Munroe sections
Munnar vs Wayanad	/kerala/munnar-vs-wayanad/	Munnar vs Wayanad; Wayanad or Munnar	Comparison section
Alleppey vs Kumarakom	/kerala/alleppey-vs-kumarakom/	Alleppey vs Kumarakom; Kumarakom or Alleppey	Backwater comparison
Varkala vs Kovalam	/kerala/varkala-vs-kovalam/	Varkala vs Kovalam; Kovalam or Varkala	Beach comparison
Kerala food guide	/kerala/kerala-food-guide/	Kerala food; what to eat in Kerala; Kerala cuisine	Food section

C. Cross-Linking Between Destination Pages

Source page	Link to	Anchor ideas	SEO purpose
Kochi guide	Munnar, Athirappilly, Alappuzha	Kochi to Munnar; Athirappilly from Kochi; Kochi to Alleppey	Use in "next stop" or route-planning sections
Munnar guide	Kochi, Thekkady, Vagamon, Wayanad comparison	Kochi to Munnar; Munnar to Thekkady; Munnar vs Wayanad	Keep Munnar tightly connected to hill-route decisions
Alappuzha guide	Kumarakom, Kochi, Varkala, backwaters guide	Alleppey vs Kumarakom; Kerala backwaters; Alleppey to Varkala	Strong cluster around backwaters and southbound route
Kumarakom guide	Alappuzha, Thekkady, backwaters guide	Kumarakom vs Alleppey; Kumarakom backwaters	Avoid isolated resort-page structure
Thekkady guide	Munnar, Alappuzha/Kumarakom	Munnar to Thekkady; Thekkady to Alleppey	Support classic central Kerala route

Source page	Link to	Anchor ideas	SEO purpose
Varkala guide	Kovalam, Thiruvananthapuram, south Kerala itinerary	Varkala vs Kovalam; places near Varkala	Strong southern Kerala cluster
Wayanad guide	Kozhikode, Kannur, Munnar comparison	Wayanad from Kozhikode; Wayanad vs Munnar	Keep Wayanad in North Kerala geography
Kozhikode guide	Wayanad, Kannur, food guide	Kozhikode to Wayanad; Malabar food; North Kerala itinerary	Build food + gateway authority
Kannur guide	Bekal, Kozhikode, Theyyam guide	Kannur to Bekal; Theyyam in Kerala; North Kerala beaches	Build cultural North Malabar cluster
Bekal guide	Kannur, North Kerala road trip	Bekal Fort; Bekal to Kannur; North Kerala itinerary	Keep Bekal connected to route, not isolated

D. Mandatory Reverse Links Back to the Kerala Pillar

Every Kerala destination, itinerary, comparison, food, monsoon and family/couples page should link back to the Kerala pillar at least once when it is contextually useful. Rotate the anchor text rather than using the same phrase everywhere.

Use these anchor variations	Recommended destination
best places to visit in Kerala	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/
Kerala travel guide	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/
Kerala tourist places	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/
plan a Kerala trip	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/
explore Kerala	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/
Kerala itinerary ideas	/places-to-visit-in-kerala/

E. Anchor Text Rules for Looptrips

- Use exact-match anchors sparingly. One natural use of "places to visit in Munnar" is enough in a section; later links can use "Munnar guide" or "explore Munnar."
- Prefer descriptive anchors over "click here," "read more," or "learn more."
- Link where the user naturally needs the next answer: route, comparison, nearby place, duration, food, transport, weather or booking.
- Do not link every mention of a destination. One strong contextual link is better than five repetitive links.
- Cross-link geographically related pages. Avoid linking Wayanad to Varkala simply because both are in Kerala unless the content genuinely compares or connects them.
- Use itinerary pages as bridges between multiple destinations, and use destination pages to feed users into itinerary pages.
- When package/booking pages exist, link them after planning-intent sections rather than stuffing commercial links into every destination paragraph.

F. Recommended Kerala Content Cluster Priority

Priority	Page	Primary keyword
1	Munnar destination page	places to visit in Munnar
2	Kochi destination page	places to visit in Kochi
3	Alappuzha destination page	places to visit in Alleppey
4	Varkala destination page	places to visit in Varkala
5	Wayanad destination page	places to visit in Wayanad
6	Thekkady destination page	places to visit in Thekkady
7	7-day Kerala itinerary	7 day Kerala itinerary
8	Kumarakom destination page	places to visit in Kumarakom
9	Kerala family guide	places to visit in Kerala with family
10	Kerala couples guide	Kerala for couples
11	Kerala monsoon guide	Kerala in monsoon
12	North Kerala road trip	North Kerala road trip

Best next page to build

Munnar should be the first Kerala destination page. It gives Looptrips a strong hill-station template and connects naturally to Kochi, Thekkady, Vagamon, family/couples content, seasonal travel and itinerary pages.

Reference Sources Used for the Kerala Guide

Kerala Tourism - Destinations: <https://www.keralatourism.org/destination/>

Kerala Tourism - Tourism Statistics 2025:

https://www.keralatourism.org/tourismstatistics/tourists_statistics_202520260507114657.pdf

Kerala Tourism - Houseboats & Backwaters: <https://www.keralatourism.org/houseboat/>

Kerala Tourism - Varkala Beach: <https://www.keralatourism.org/destination/varkala-beach/328/>

Kerala Tourism - Wayanad: <https://www.keralatourism.org/destination/wayanad-district/373/>

Kerala Tourism - Athirappilly & Vazhachal: <https://www.keralatourism.org/destination/athirappalli-vazhachal-waterfalls/79/>

Kerala Tourism - Kannur / North Malabar: <https://www.keralatourism.org/districts/kannur/>

Kerala Responsible Tourism Mission: <https://www.keralatourism.org/responsible-tourism/experience>